



*August 2026
50th Year of Growth
1976 - 2026*



Contact Email: secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com
Web Address: www.doncastergardenclubaus.com

The DGC committee meeting was held on 5th August 2026 at 7.30 pm.
The next DGC meeting will be held on **Wednesday, 12 August 2026**
7.30 pm at the RSL Hall , cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street. Doors open at 7.15pm

At this meeting we have a Questions & Answer session where members can ask questions and also share their knowledge of how to deal with issues in the garden

Committee Members 2026

President
Avril Clark
0402 478 302
president@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Vice-President & Speaker Bookings:
Vacant

Treasurer:
Dr Margaret Salter

Secretary:
Virginia Roberts & Connie Lee
secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Fund Raising Co-Ordinator:
Anita Lizza

Newsletter:
Rohini Padey
newseditor@doncastergardenclubaus.com

**Reinhard
Esther Sim**

Ray Brett

President's Message - August 2026

Here we are at the last month of Winter and how quickly the year is slipping past. How has your garden fared with all the rain? I now have a superabundance of Nasturtiums which I'm going to have to cut back as they are swamping everything else! I am trying to finish the last of the rose pruning whilst dodging the showers and the roses are already shooting.

The bulbs are all up and the Jonquils are flowering, as well as the Daphne at my front door.

I'm looking forward to seeing you all at the Club's 50th on Saturday 3rd October 2026. The committee are working hard to make it a special celebration. Please do get in touch with us if you would like to assist us on the day, your help will be

There will be no message next month as I shall be away.

We have organised a Brunch meet for 29th August
@ Heidi café at 11 am. Their breakfast menu is
available 9am to 11:30am. Lunch is available after
11:30am.

We will need RSVPs at the Wednesday meeting so
we can book a table.

Doncaster Garden Club Subscriptions are due for renewal by the 31st October 2026

Please bring your returnable bottles and cans each month so we can collect the 10c deposit to add to the DGC financial reserve. (No squashed cans please)

Speaker for July - Bruno Tigani - Commercial Vegetable Seed Industry

Bruno shared with us his knowledge of the Farming industry and insights into the countries where farming is carried on a large scale. he mentioned that there is a massive amount of science, testing, and care that goes into getting a uniform, high-performing plant out of a simple packet. Uniform seed vitality and smart crop care dictate everything from a healthy harvest to resilient soil. When the Seed industry is testing seeds they need to perform a series of tests on the seeds and also ensure that the seeds produce plants that are healthy and that will fruit in abundance.

There is a lot of science behind farming and he stated that Europe is ahead of the game in terms of farming and supplying the world with seeds and produce. He said that that Netherlands is in the front of the pack and that they have large greenhouses where they grow tomatoes hydroponically.

He also talked about fertilisers that farmers use and the pesticides used for control of bugs. He showed us pictures of some of the produce he grows in his garden in Lower Plenty and as you can imagine his produce looks fantastic.

It was a very engaging talk and he was kind enough to bring a lot of seedlings to share with us - lettuce, broccoli and other winter vegetables.



Upcoming Calendar Events:

Upcoming Committee Meeting:	05 August	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Upcoming Meeting:	12 August	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East
Following Committee Meeting:	02 September	hosted by Virgina Roberts , 7.30pm
Following Meeting:	09 September	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East
Speaker at the September meeting: Clare Harvey on growing different varieties of Corn		

Citrus Gall Wasp

Control of these have been difficult in Melbourne as, at this stage, predator release is not possible (as happens in Queensland). However, recent new product development has given hope to gardeners in southern Australia. A new product based entirely on calcined Kaolin clay (Overhaul), and organically rated, has been found to dramatically reduce the size and number of galls.

Best practice includes:

- Reduce the amount of soft spring flush growth by pruning (and gall removal) and fertilising in late summer or autumn instead of late winter and spring .Use a balanced fertiliser rather than a highly nitrogenous one.
- Spraying with Overhaul (a kaolin clay product) in spring and summer
- Placing sticky traps (see below) into the trees around spring to catch emerging wasps and prevent them mating and laying eggs into the new growth. Adult wasps don't fly far. They can be moved good distances by wind, but will tend to re-infect the tree they emerged from. Hence traps are useful to prevent re-infection.
- Remove galls before spring, wrap and place in your rubbish bin (NOT your greenwaste bin).
- Where possible, get neighbours involved and protecting their trees as well.

Article courtesy of Bullen Art and Garden magazine - Please read the detailed article on their website

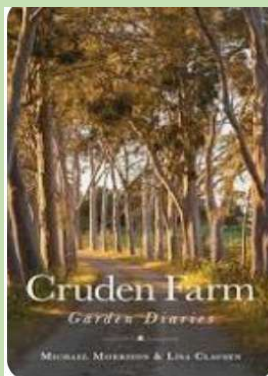
<https://baag.com.au/citrus-gall-wasp/>

From My Bookshelf - August 2026

Cruden Farm Diaries. Michael Morrison & Lisa Clausen

If you have never visited Cruden Farm in Langwarrin then please make a strenuous attempt to do so. This is a world class garden right on our doorstep that was tenderly nurtured and envisioned by Dame Elizabeth Murdoch and her special gardener Michael Morrison.

The diaries document the evolution of this extraordinary garden and the enormous vision of Dame Elizabeth and her gardener. Dame Elizabeth was no armchair expert – she could often be found on her knees weeding the garden beds well into her eighties. Her botanical knowledge was encyclopaedic and she sourced many rare and exotic plants for her garden.



The book is magnificently illustrated by Simon Griffiths as well as being replete with wonderful anecdotes such as the time she found Michael catching fish in the Walled Garden pond; she was soon in the water in her stockings wanting to help...”

The garden is regularly open to the public and you can check the times at CrudenFarm.com I am sure you will not be disappointed.



Hello Gardeners All

Two camelias are still flowering - a red Czar (possibly)- and a pink older variety of which the flowers hang down. The white flowered variegated Daphne smells gorgeous!

I've measured 45mm rain last month and 10 this month and there is more due Sunday and Monday before this newsletter arrives. My yard is still very wet and difficult to garden easily. It just shows how shallow the topsoil is and how close the less absorbent clay sits beneath.

Two tomato plants in 250mm pots on the protected patio for the winter (self sown in the garden in late autumn) have given me a total of 4 tomatoes.

The mostly warmer than average winter has radish and bok choy plants going to seed. The radishes are small and the tops not excessively big but so much edible leaf in comparison to root. I am planning to blanch, chill, dry then freeze some.

Two lots of snap peas are climbing. The tallest are flowering. The cauliflowers and broccolini are growing well at perhaps half size. The early broccoli all have had their main head removed and I'm waiting for side shoots which takes some weeks. One plant has some nearly ready.

The shallots and leeks seem to be doing well but won't be ready until possibly December. There is a very small number of carrots ready as most of the seeds didn't grow and two more plantings at different stages.

The broadbeans which failed to shoot what with wet soil over the last 2 months now has a number of plants growing well. I actually planted each seed in a toilet roll cardboard to then transplant the seedlings. Much more successful this year.

A rat, presumably, has eaten 2 cauliflower seedlings of the next four planted! So frustrating. I bought a punnet of red onions. It must contain a hundred seedlings. I have some in 2 beds on the circumference hoping to keep rats away but they need to be much larger I think.

Trevor dug a trench in an empty bed to bury 2 buckets of spent bokashi. The liquid has all run off. The residue of vegetable scraps, etc, with the fermenting grain husks are now making the area rich for a summer crop.

I have self sown tagetes/marigold popping up and these have been put into seedling containers for replanting where needed to protect each bed from aphid, etc. They are supposed to protect plants by encouraging friendly insects.

Happy Gardening Pauline

Garden Visit - Villa Taranto Botanical Garden in Verbania

On my recent trip to Northern Italy I visited a stunning garden in Verbania called Villa Taranto Gardens Italian name - Giardini Botanici di Villa Taranto in Verbania. This garden is a short walk from the main square in Verbania. I enjoyed my visit to Verbania as well, the town square has beautiful cafes/restaurants where you can relax and have an aperitivos. This garden is next to Lake Maggiore and while it is not as grand as the Gardens of Isola Bella which is on Lake Maggiore, it was very special. The size is impressive and as you walk around you discover a lot of treasures. These gardens were established between 1931 and 1940 by Scottish Captain Neil McEacharn, the 16-hectare estate seamlessly blends an English-style landscape with a vast collection of over 20,000 global plant varieties

There are long winding paths with direct, panoramic outlooks over the shimmering expanse of Lake Maggiore and the distant Alps.

The attractions include the 'Terraced Garden' pictured below with waterfalls and waterlily ponds, the 'Winter Garden,' and the 'Bog Garden.' There was a stunning Dahlias display when I was there in June. And they do have a tulip display in Spring.

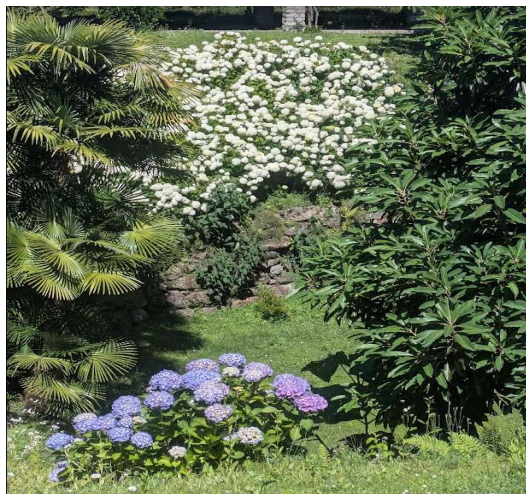
It was an enjoyable afternoon wandering around the gardens and discovering all the different plants species from around the world, it is said he travelled over the world to collect the 20,000 plant species.

This garden has a connection to Melbourne - Captain Neil Mc Eacharn's father was Sir Malcolm Donald McEacharn, a prominent Australian shipping magnate and politician who also served as Lord Mayor of Melbourne.

With the Second World War imminent, McEacharn left Italy for Australia in 1939. He gave his garden to the Italian State on condition that it remained private. Returning at the end of the war, he was encouraged to open the garden to the public, which he did in 1952.

Tucked within the lush flora are tranquil fountains, cascading waterfalls, and the peaceful Mausoleum where Captain McEacharn rests

Rohini Padey



Tree Planted in
1938

Hello Gardeners

Cranbourne Botanic Gardens - Have any of you visited these gardens. If not, now is a perfect time to do so as they have daily tours to take you through the gardens. I plan to go there in a few weeks time. Daily at 11am there is a 1.5 hour tour that invites you to venture through the highlights of the Australian Garden with one of their experienced guides. Discover what's in bloom, explore the diversity of Australian plants, and hear stories about the garden's award-winning design and the unique landscapes it brings to life. These tours are Free but bookings are essential

For private

group bookings, please call 03 5990 2200 or email mbookings@rbg.vic.gov.au.

For more details - <https://www.rbg.vic.gov.au/cranbourne-gardens/whatson-cranbourne/free-australian-garden-walk/>

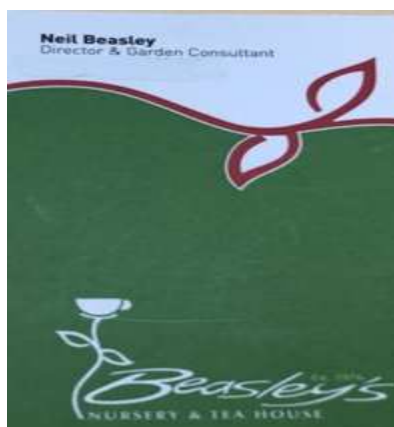
Rohini



DGC Life Members

Gerda van der Peet
Doug Brewer
Gayle McCann
Ted Page

Joanne Driver
Elsie Carter
Bev Turner
Franziska Kung



The Ryset Catalogue can be found online:

<https://ryset.com>

The Club receives wholesale prices which means discounts of up to 60-70%



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